Charwell Challenge

Written Briefing Notes

6 and 3 hour Rogaines
Saturday 19 March 2016

Dear Team,

Team No.

Thank you for your entry. Please get your team number from the website, **enter it in the box here, bring this with you**, and remember it.

Please ensure all team members are familiar with all information below. It is also accessible at http://www.rogaine.org.nz. We hope you enjoy Charwell Challenge.

Getting to the event

REGISTRATION and START/FINISH is at Surrey Downs, 2791 Inland Kaikoura Road. Coming via Waiau, it is 29 km beyond Mt Lyford, 2 km over Charwell River bridge, turning right into Surrey Downs immediately after the 'Welcome to Kaikoura District' sign. Coming via Kaikoura, it is 28km beyond the Inland Road turnoff, 4 km after the Green Burn Creek bridge and turning left into Surrey Downs immediately after the 'Welcome to Hurunui District' sign. Allow 2.5 hrs travel time from Christchurch via Waiau. You are welcome to camp overnight at the venue.

Registration

At registration ensure your team is together and that you have your completed **Indemnity and Emergency Contact form** (included below). Your team will be issued with:

- an event map (A4, 1:40,000 scale topo map with magnetic north lines marked), a checkpoint description sheet, and an A4 zip lock plastic bag per team member.
- a single B&W A4 version of the map for your '**flight plan'**. Enter your team number and plot your intended route on this map, including direction of travel, and return it to registration before the start. (You may modify your route according to conditions as you progress, but the flight plan gives us an idea of your likely whereabouts.)
- A page of ancillary notes about the course
- Check point punch card - one per team. (This provides evidence your team has visited the check point.)

Start

- All team members must attend the verbal briefing, 15 minutes before the start.
- All teams must hand in their flight plan before the event starts.

Finish

At the finish line, with all your team members assembled, hand over your check point punch card. The finisher will enter your finish time, and note how many points must be deducted from your score if you finished after the official finishing time late. The finisher will take your CP punch card for scoring, (If there is queue we may ask you to self score, and we will check later.) If you disagree with the score, or about the location of a check point, see the event organiser. Scores will be available ASAP on the day and will be published on http://www.rogaine.org.nz as soon as possible.

Your event will close after the 6 or 3 hrs has elapsed. Aim to finish on time as you will be penalised 10 points per minute late and if you are over 30 minutes late you lose all your points.

Event chronology

	6hr	3hr
REGISTRATION OPENS Route planning and preparation	8.30am	10.30am
Briefing	9.45am	11.45am
START	10am	12 noon
FINISH	4pm	3pm
RESULTS	ASAP after 4.30pm	ASAP after 3.30pm
Post-event meal (ask at the time for vege or gluten-free options) Scottish bap with lettuce in mint vinaigrette and roast lamb, or venison and coleslaw, plus fruit. Pupils from Kaikoura Suburban School will offer ice creams and sweets, so bring some change.		

What to bring

Essential clothing and safety equipment is listed under 'Safety Sheet'. You will also need

- marker pens, pencils and highlighters, pins and string, and ruler, for planning and measuring your route before you start
- folding outdoor seats, and maybe a folding camp table for course planning

Compass only – other navigation devices such as altimeters or GPS are **not allowed**.

Food and drink

Carry enough for a day in the field. Two litres of water each is good. Water refill drops are marked on the map, and you can fill up at the Start/Finish. We discourage drawing water from streams.

Event procedure

We recommend you spend up to an hour planning your route, making the day more enjoyable and rewarding. (Depending on weather you may end up sitting in the car to do this.)

Plan your route to challenge your map reading and navigation skills but staying within the safe limits set by the terrain and weather, and your experience and fitness. If your team lacks confidence in finding its way in moderate, untracked tramping terrain, stick to the more accessible check points.

Your team may visit any number of check points and in any order. Your aim is to maximise your 'score'. The checkpoints each have a unique number and the score value is the first digit followed by a zero. Thus checkpoint number 23 has a score of 20 points and 91 a score of 90 points. Checkpoints numbered 100s are worth 100 points.

All teams start together. Concentrate on your own team plan. On the course do not try to follow other teams, or get distracted by them as they may have set a different route. Always keep aware of your team's location on the map.

Not all tracks and fences are marked on the map, and others are mapped that no longer exist. Tracks and fences are handy to guide navigation, but do not assume their detailed accuracy.

Team members must always stay in verbal contact with each other, and <u>all</u> must visit each checkpoint.

Clip-your-card at the check point procedure: At each checkpoint there is an orange/white flag tied to a bush or post etc. (usually knee to shoulder height) a yellow numbered tag and an orange card punch. These are not hidden and visible from at least 10 m away, depending on your approach. (If a CP is missing, make a note of the location to convince the organizers you reached the correct place - a photo maybe.) At the flag, firmly clip your punch card in the **correctly numbered cell** (the same as the CP number code) with the orange 'ticket clipper', **ensuring the spikes have pierced the card**. Do not double clip. If you inadvertently clip in the wrong cell use a spare cell or the bottom margin for that CP and annotate the card, and tell the scorer at the finish.

Safety Sheet – Charwell Challenge
6 and 3 hour Rogaines - Saturday 19 March 2016

Cancellation
This event will be cancelled only if conditions are severe. The organisers may shorten the event by time or geography for safety or other reasons.

Compulsory clothes and equipment:

Per team member:	thermal top & trousers	thermal hat and gloves
	shower proof/windproof coat	survival sheet or pack liner
	whistle,	food, water bottle
	robust, well-fitting footwear with well-treaded soles	
Per team:	small first aid kit	at least one compass (but no GPS)
	watch	pencil, biro, or fine spirit marker
	torch (just in case)	

Your gear is your own responsibility. There is no compulsory gear check but the organisers reserve the right to do checks on a random or selective basis.

Depending on weather on the day, we **strongly recommend** you also carry: a fully rainproof parka, second layer thermal top, long gaiters, showerproof over trousers. Gaiters are always good to save your legs from scratches.

Cell phone coverage is patchy and confined to topographic high points. Organisers can be reached on landline 03 319 7585. (We expect to have one or two roving marshalls on the course, with radio contact back to base.)

"Always be aware of your surroundings"

Safety is a top priority. Organisers and participants (you) have responsibilities for safety, including:

- meeting safety requirements given by event organisers in writing, on web site, or verbally,
- carrying compulsory protective clothing and other safety equipment,
- advising team member(s) of any medical conditions you have, your general level of fitness and other factors that may affect you during the event,
- staying together as a team at all times, and helping any other team in difficulties,
- depositing a 'flight plan' map showing your intended course before you start,
- advising organisers and returning your score card if you withdraw from the event, or when you finish. This is our safety check you are no longer on the course and **IS COMPULSORY,**
- being conscious of time and avoiding a late return – being late results in a hefty points penalty as well as raising safety concerns,
- being prepared to modify your plans to be more conservative if safety conditions dictate this,
- monitoring team and individual progress and fitness and modifying plans as required,
- looking out for hazards, such as:
    1. **Hypothermia.** Wind, water and cold can lead to exposure or hypothermia. Early symptoms are subtle (clumsiness, lethargy, slurred speech). Seek shelter or to call it a day if conditions are severe, or if any of your team is becoming exhausted. Keep off high, exposed ridges.
    2. **Dehydration.** we suggest you carry at least 2 litres per person.
    3. **Streams**. Do not cross streams if they are heavily swollen.
    4. **Cliffs, loose rocks, incised creeks, gullies, obstacles like loose fencing wire**, may be present throughout.

5. **Fog/low cloud**. If in fog, orientate the map and yourself with a compass. If in doubt, don't climb into cloud, and descend out of it as soon as possible.
6. **Hunters**: unlikely on this course, but be alert – if in doubt be visible and vocal.
7. **Electric fences**. Usually the top wire, but sometimes a lower wire, may be hot (look for insulators on the post). Treat all electric fences as ON. Climb through between non-live wires, or use parka, pack or map for insulation.
8. **Stock**. Generally not a hazard, but be alert and avoid crowding any stock. **Keep out of deer paddocks**, indicated by 2m-high netting fences
9. **Earthquake**. There are major faults nearby. Keep aware of your surroundings. Rocks falling from above are likely your greatest danger. Open, low-angle ground is likely to be safest.

In the event of injury or exhaustion, make the injured person warm and comfortable; arrange, if possible, to leave someone with them; note your exact location on the map; seek help from other passing teams. Emergency signal – repeated (6 or more) short blasts on whistle, repeated every few minutes. Repeat if you hear one long blast.

Road safety

The Inland Kaikoura Road is open to traffic. Normal Road Code rules for pedestrians and vehicles apply. You may NOT use the road as a corridor except in an emergency. You may cross the road only at the three crossing points marked on the map. These are conveniently located for check point access.

Farm and Environmental Care

Rogaining is an environmentally & socially friendly activity – please reinforce this ethic.

- Respect farm stock, fences and other facilities, and the right of landowners to operate their business, and lifestyle.
- Out-of-bounds means just that.
- Do not crowd or corner stock or otherwise disturb stock.
- No crossing into deer paddocks (deer fences are 2m high mesh).
- **LEAVE GATES AS YOU FIND THEM.** You open gate, you close it - **PROPERLY**.
- Cross fences at a strainer post, or climb through. Do not spring off the top wire.
- Report any damage or distress to stock to the organizers.
- Remove rubbish – more importantly, don't create it in the first place
- Bury toilet waste - better still, use the toilets at the event centre.
- Keep streams clean
- Fire risk: Don't carry any 'fire tools'
- No dogs, thank you

This event is wholly on private land and we gratefully thank the families on Surrey Downs, Hawk Hills and Green Hills. Please ensure the trust they have placed in us is justified.

Thank you, Grant Hunter, for NZ Rogaining Association and H&S Kaikoura Suburban School

Charwell Challenge - Saturday 19 March 2016

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following has been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity (signed by each member of a team)

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organizers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves (including vehicles at the event venue) resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining. We understand the safety requirements set out by the organisers.

Team members under 16 must have their name countersigned by a parent/caregiver

Name	Signature	Date	Age (years) on event day

Emergency Contact for each member of a team

Your name and Car Registration Number (the one that brought you here)	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition (optional)